

Cognitive Walkthrough

CeraVe · desktop version

Individual cognitive walkthrough · September 26–28

Method	Lewis & Rieman (1994) four-question walkthrough
Tasks evaluated	3 intermediate-level shopping tasks
Severity scale	0–4 (Nielsen)
Sessions	3 evaluator sessions, ~60 min each

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Description

Website

CeraVe is a global skincare brand known for products formulated by dermatologists. It offers skincare solutions such as cleansers, moisturizers, and serums.

Purpose

The official CeraVe website (desktop version) serves three main purposes:

Product discovery and education

The site introduces users to the various products CeraVe offers while educating them about ingredients and skin concerns.

E-commerce and purchase facilitation

The site functions as a storefront, displaying product details that enable users to browse, compare, and purchase products. It also links to partner retailers that sell their products.

Brand trust creation

The site builds dermatologist-backed credibility through product claims, articles, and scientific content, helping users make informed choices.

Primary users

The primary users of CeraVe products include (but are not limited to):

- General consumers looking for affordable, dermatologist-approved skincare products.
- Health-conscious shoppers researching products by skin concern, ingredient, and skin type.
- Parents and caregivers selecting gentle products for babies and kids.
- Returning customers looking to repurchase the same or try different products.

Summary of the Method

Approach

The individual cognitive walkthrough applied to the CeraVe website follows Lewis & Rieman's (1994) four guiding questions for each step in a task:

1. Will users be trying to produce whatever effect the action has?
2. Will users see the control (button, menu, switch, etc.) for the action?
3. Once users find the control, will they recognize that it produces the effect they want?
4. After the action is taken, will users understand the feedback they get, so they can move on with confidence?

Tasks under evaluation

1. Locate the list of retailers to buy the “Daily Moisturizing Lotion” from.
2. Complete the “Skincare Solution Finder” quiz.
3. Compare “Hydrating Facial Cleanser” and “Foaming Facial Cleanser.”

Rating scale used

Severity ratings (0–4) are assigned wherever problems are identified:

Rating	Definition
0	The issue is minor and does not impact system usability.
1	Cosmetic problem only — fix only if there is extra time on the project.
2	Minor usability problem — fixing this should be given low priority.
3	Major usability problem that is important to fix — high priority.
4	Usability catastrophe — imperative to fix before the product launches.

Session schedule

Three evaluator sessions (around 60 minutes each) to map happy paths, apply the walkthrough questions step-by-step, assign severity, and collect evidence (screenshots) and notes. Sessions were conducted September 26–28.

Reference

nngroup.com/articles/cognitive-walkthroughs

Tasks & Happy Paths

The following three tasks were selected at an intermediate task level. Each lists the ideal “happy path” a user would follow to complete it.

Task 1 — Locate retailers for the Daily Moisturizing Lotion

1. Navigate to the “Skincare” menu.
2. Select “Facial Moisturizers.”
3. Browse the product grid and select “Daily Moisturizing Lotion.”
4. Click the product to open its details page.
5. Review the product details (size, price, description).
6. Click “Buy Online.”
7. View the list of external retailers (e.g., Target, CVS, Walmart).

Task 2 — Complete the “Skincare Solution Finder” quiz

1. Scroll down the homepage until the “Skincare Solution Finder” quiz section appears.
2. Click the “Take the quiz” button.
3. Click the “Let’s go!” button.
4. Take the quiz (Q1–6: skin concerns, breakouts, skin type, makeup areas, sunscreen, body concern).
5. Click “Show results.”
6. Click “No thanks, take me to my results.”
7. Review the recommended product details page.

Task 3 — Compare Hydrating and Foaming Facial Cleansers

1. Navigate to the “Skincare” menu.
2. Select “Facial Cleansers.”
3. Click the “Compare Facial Cleansers” button.
4. Locate “Hydrating Facial Cleanser” and “Foaming Facial Cleanser.”
5. Review the comparison chart.
6. Compare ingredients.
7. Compare product claims / benefits.
8. Compare usage recommendations.

Task 1 — Locate the list of retailers to buy the Daily Moisturizing Lotion from.

#	Action	Q1 — Goal?	Q2 — See control?	Q3 — Recognize?	Q4 — Feedback?	Result	Severity
1	Navigate to the “Skincare” menu.	Yes — users know lotion is a skincare product.	Yes — “Skincare” is visible in top nav.	Yes — the label is clear.	Yes — the dropdown shows the categories for the next step.	Success	0
2	Select “Facial Moisturizers.”	Yes — moisturizer matches their intent.	Yes — it’s visible in the dropdown.	Yes — the label is clear.	Yes — the page loads moisturizer products.	Success	0
3	Browse the product grid and select “Daily Moisturizing Lotion.”	Yes — they’re looking for this specific product.	Yes — visible in grid, though scanning takes some effort.	Yes — the product title is clear.	Yes — the details page loads.	Success	1 (scanning the grid takes time)
4	Click the product to open its details page.	Yes — users expect the details page next.	Yes — the product card is clickable.	Yes — standard e-commerce behavior.	Yes — the details page loads.	Success	0
5	Click “Buy Online.”	Yes — they want to purchase.	Yes — the button is visible.	No — “Buy Online” implies checkout on CeraVe, not a redirect.	No — an unexpected redirect happens.	Failure	3 (misleading label; breaks the checkout expectation)
6	View the list of external retailers (Target, CVS, Walmart).	Yes — they expect to choose a store.	Yes — the list displays.	Yes — the logos are recognizable.	Yes, but leaving CeraVe may feel unexpected.	Success	2 (show prices so users can compare and decide)

Task 2 — Complete the “Skincare Solution Finder” quiz.

#	Action	Q1 — Goal?	Q2 — See control?	Q3 — Recognize?	Q4 — Feedback?	Result	Severity
1	Scroll the homepage until the “Skincare Solution Finder” quiz appears.	Yes — they may be seeking product recommendations.	No — the quiz section isn’t clearly visible; it may be missed.	Yes — users might grasp the quiz’s purpose.	Yes — if found, the banner signals purpose.	Failure	3 (the quiz placement makes it hard to reach)
2	Click the “Take the quiz” button.	Yes — users want help.	Yes — the button is visible on the quiz.	Yes — the label matches expectation.	Yes — a new quiz intro page loads.	Success	0
3	Click the “Let’s go!” button.	Yes — a natural start action.	Yes — the button is visible.	Yes — the label is clear.	Yes — the first question loads.	Success	0
4	Take the quiz (questions 1–6).	Yes — answering is expected.	Yes — each question and its options are shown.	Yes, but some questions use jargony words.	Yes — a loading message is displayed.	Success	1 (some wording may read as jargon)
5	Click “Show results.”	Yes — the next step is to see results.	Yes — the button is visible.	Yes — the label is clear.	No — a small form asking for details appears first.	Success	1 (a form right after “Show results” breaks expectations)
6	Click “No thanks, take me to my results.”	Yes — they want results, not extra prompts.	Yes — the button appears after the quiz.	Yes — the wording is clear.	Yes — the results page loads.	Success	0
7	Review the recommended product details page.	Yes — users expect recommendations.	Yes — results are displayed.	Yes, but the layout creates confusion.	No — the volume of recommended products overwhelms.	Failure	3 (too many recommended products confuses users)

Task 3 — Compare Hydrating Facial Cleanser and Foaming Facial Cleanser.

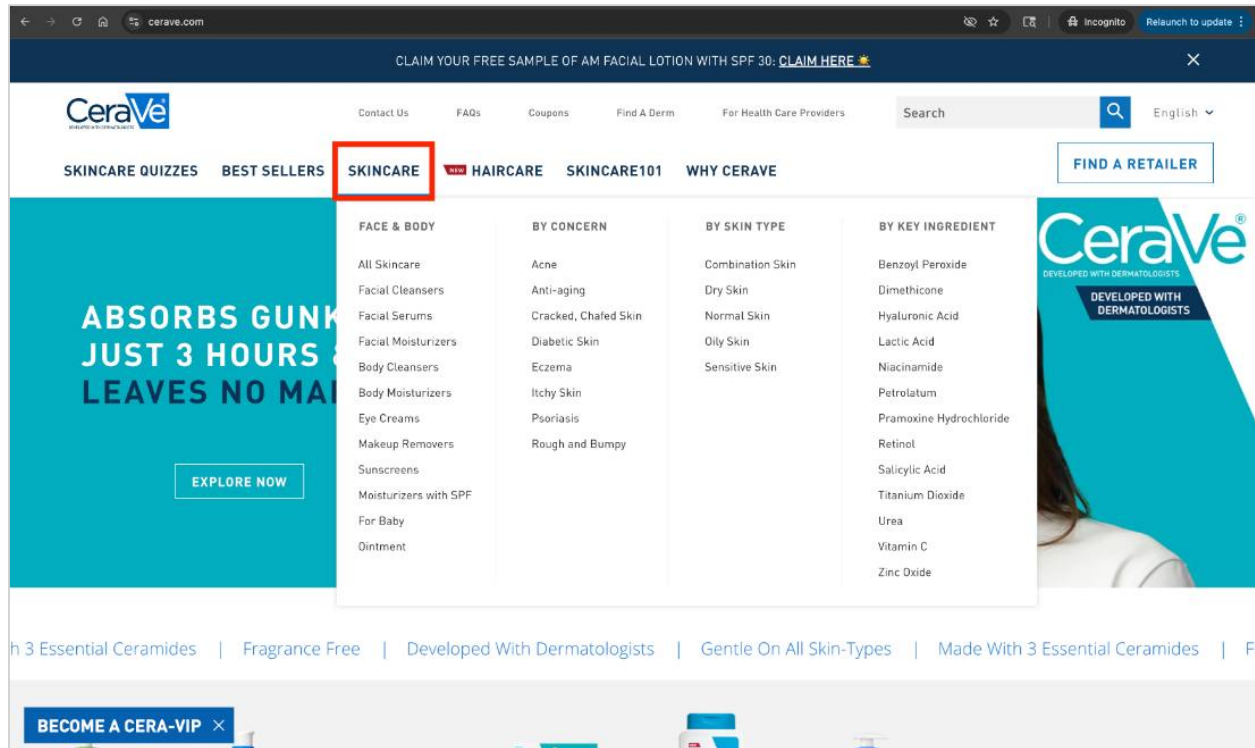
#	Action	Q1 — Goal?	Q2 — See control?	Q3 — Recognize?	Q4 — Feedback?	Result	Severity
1	Navigate to the “Skincare” menu.	Yes — cleansers are skincare products.	Yes — “Skincare” is visible in top nav.	Yes — the label is clear.	Yes — the dropdown shows the categories.	Success	0
2	Select “Facial Cleansers.”	Yes — cleansers match their intent.	Yes — it’s visible in the dropdown.	Yes — the label is clear.	Yes — the page loads cleanser products.	Success	0
3	Click the “Compare Facial Cleansers” button.	Yes — they want to compare products.	Yes — the button is visible.	Yes — the wording is clear.	Yes — the comparison page loads.	Success	0
4	Locate “Hydrating” and “Foaming” Facial Cleansers.	Yes — common products to compare.	Yes — the products are listed.	Yes — names match packaging.	Yes — users can view details to compare.	Success	0
5	Review the comparison chart.	Yes — users want to see differences.	Yes — the chart is displayed.	No — ingredient info sits far from the ingredient list.	Yes — users can still take action.	Success	1 (move ingredient info nearer the list)

Appendix — Screenshots

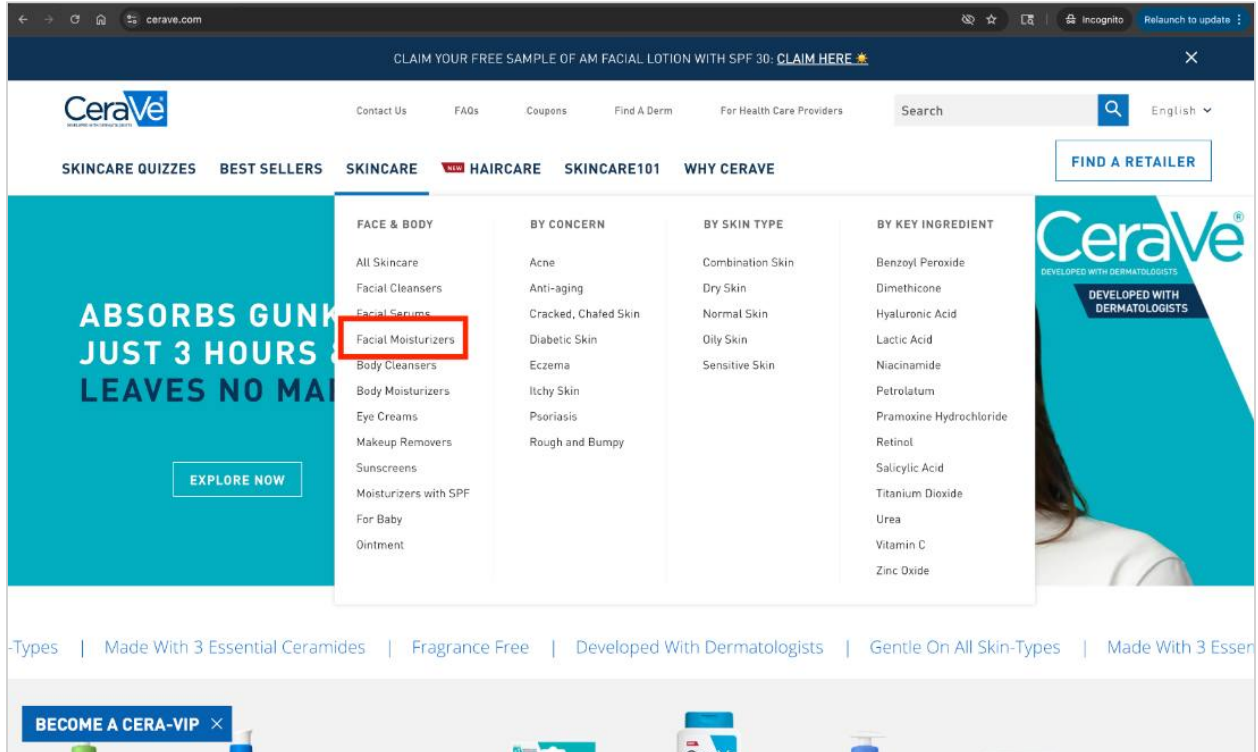
Screenshots for each action step in the walkthrough, numbered to match the tables above.

Task 1 — Locate retailers

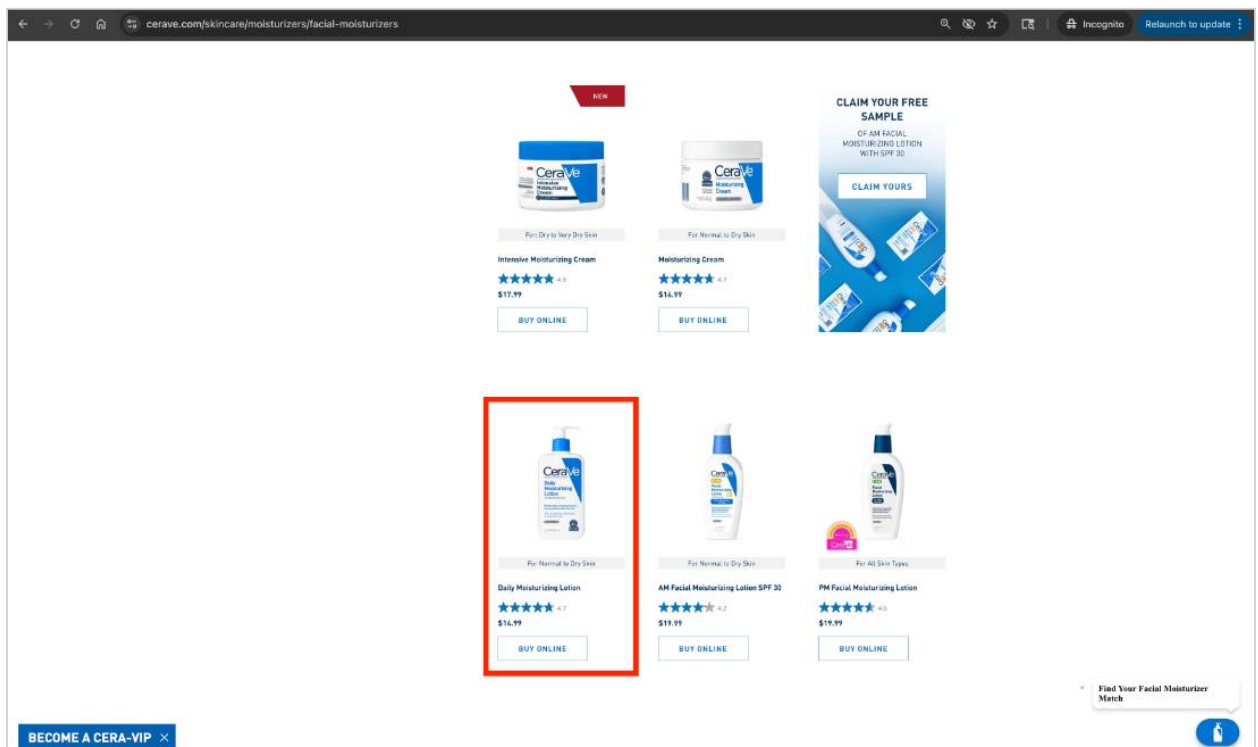
Step 1 — Skincare menu



Step 2 — Facial Moisturizers



Step 3 — Product grid



Step 4 — Product details page

cerave.com/skincare/moisturizers/daily-moisturizing-lotion

CLAIM YOUR FREE SAMPLE OF AM FACIAL LOTION WITH SPF 30. [CLAIM HERE](#)

CeraVe

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SKINCARE QUIZZES BEST SELLERS SKINCARE HAIRCARE SKINCARE101 WHY CERAVE

FIND A RETAILER

Home / Skincare / Moisturizers / Daily Moisturizing Lotion



Daily Moisturizing Lotion

★★★★★ 4.7 (1556) [Write a review](#)

CeraVe Daily Moisturizing Lotion is a lightweight, oil-free moisturizer with three essential ceramides that locks in skin's moisture and helps restore the skin's protective barrier.

Useable for both men and women.

- Made For: Normal to Dry Skin
- Helps With: Hydration

\$14.99

[BUY ONLINE](#) [FIND IN STORES](#)

SAVE NOW! Up to \$2.00 on every product >

 I recommend CeraVe Moisturizing Lotion for daily use on even the most sensitive skin types because it contains no sulfates or fragrance and helps restore and protect dry skin.
DR. LATANYA BENJAMIN, BOARD CERTIFIED DERMATOLOGIST

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Need help finding the right body moisturizer for you? Take our 2-question quiz!

Step 5 — Buy Online

cerave.com/skincare/moisturizers/daily-moisturizing-lotion

CLAIM YOUR FREE SAMPLE OF AM FACIAL LOTION WITH SPF 30. [CLAIM HERE](#)

CeraVe

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SKINCARE QUIZZES BEST SELLERS SKINCARE HAIRCARE SKINCARE101 WHY CERAVE

FIND A RETAILER

Home / Skincare / Moisturizers / Daily Moisturizing Lotion



Daily Moisturizing Lotion

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[BUY ONLINE](#) [FIND IN STORES](#)

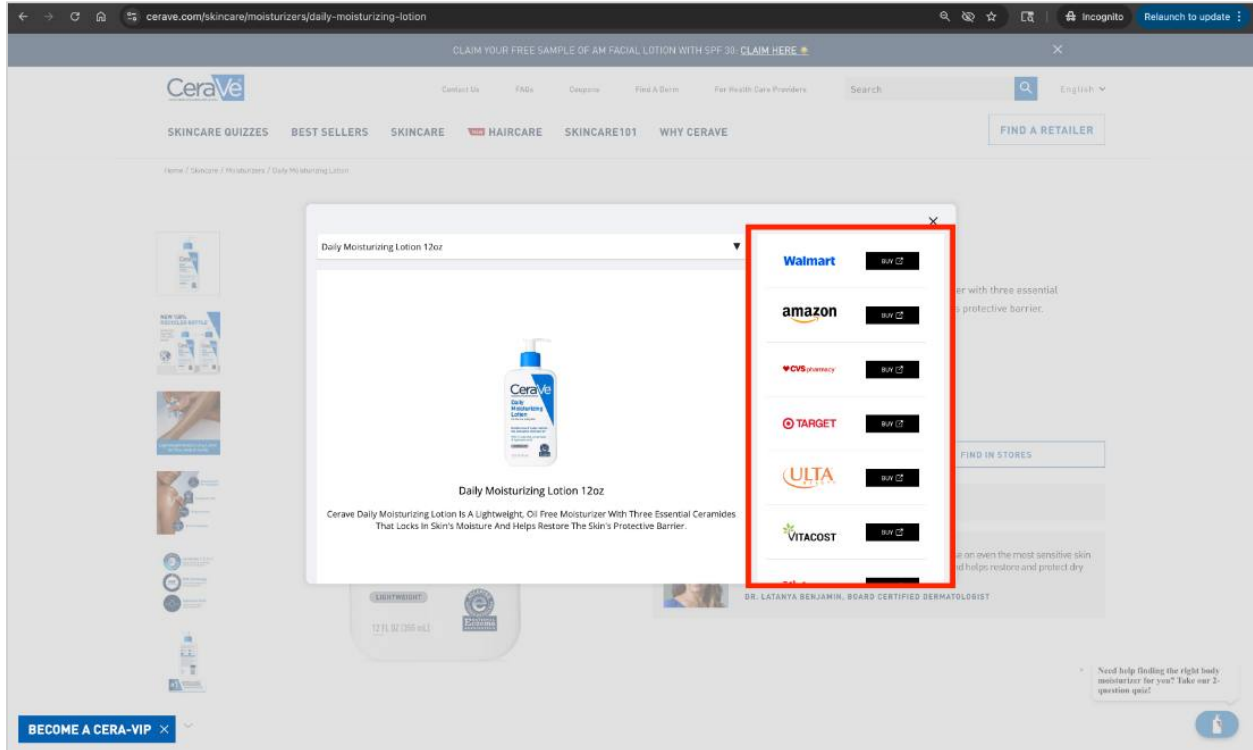
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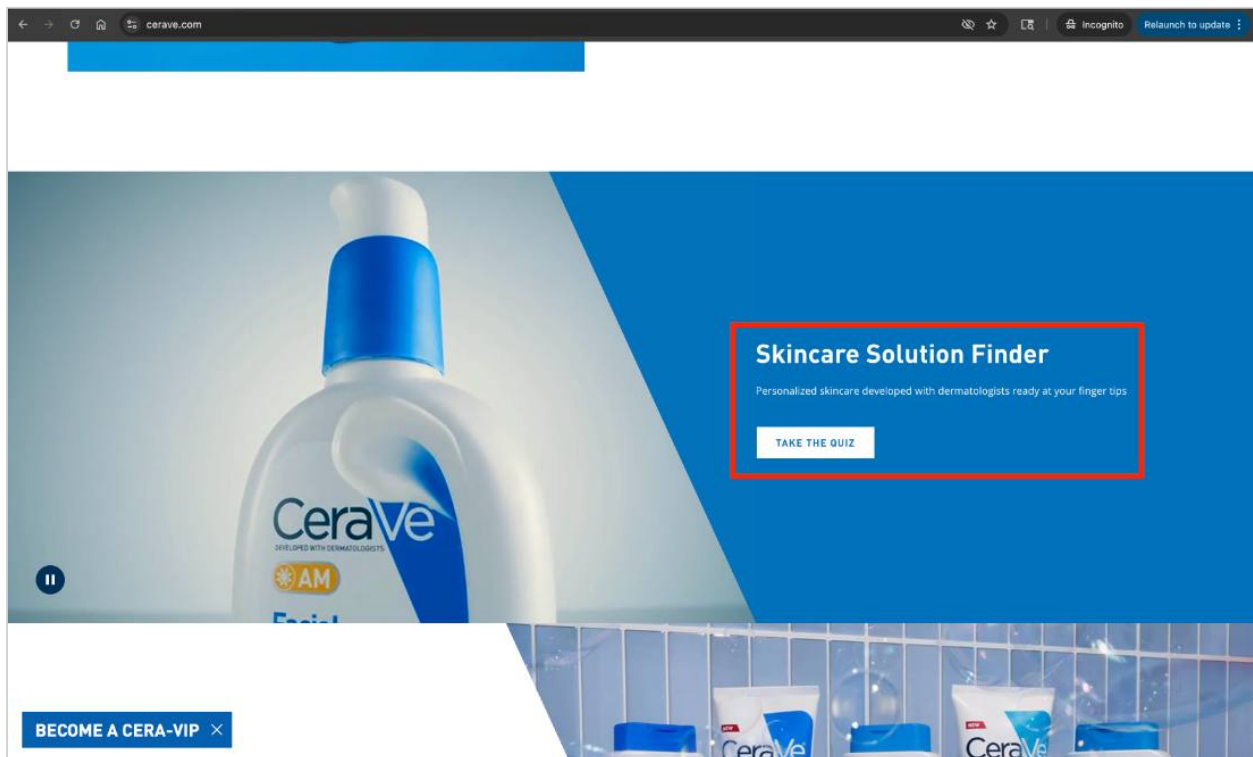
Need help finding the right body moisturizer for you? Take our 2-question quiz!

Step 6 — Retailer list

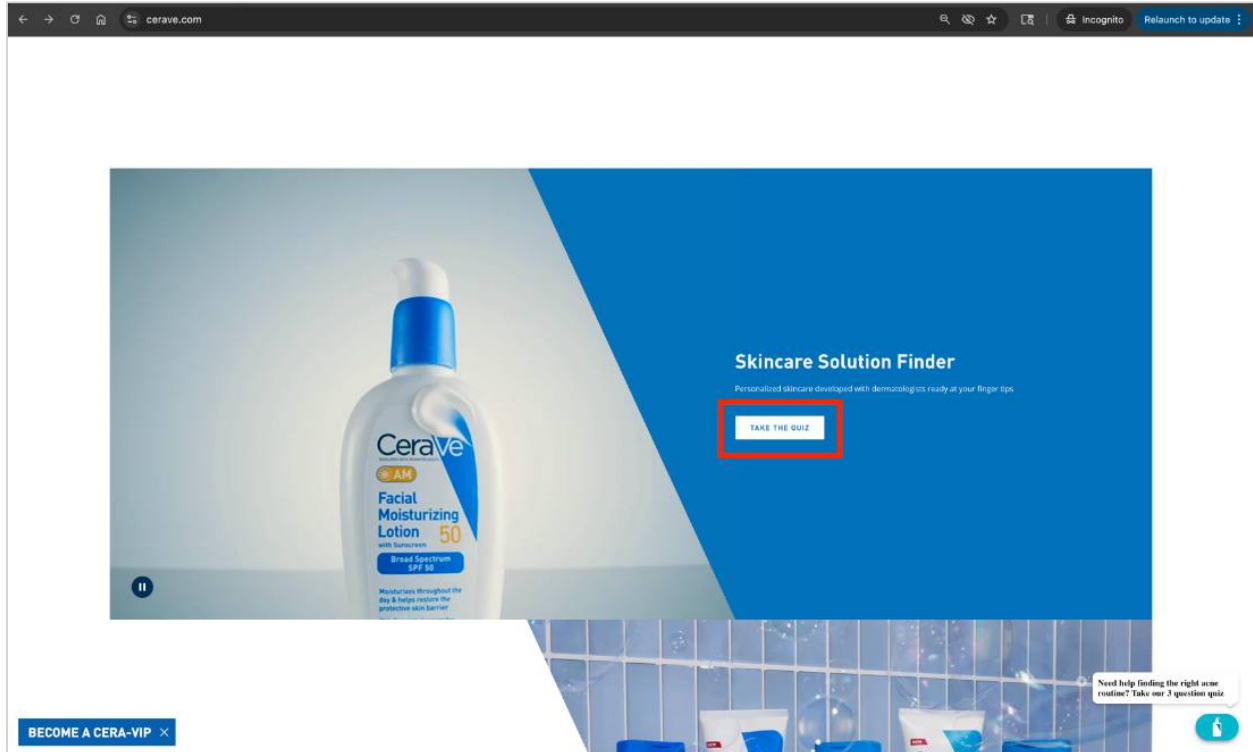


Task 2 — Skincare Solution Finder quiz

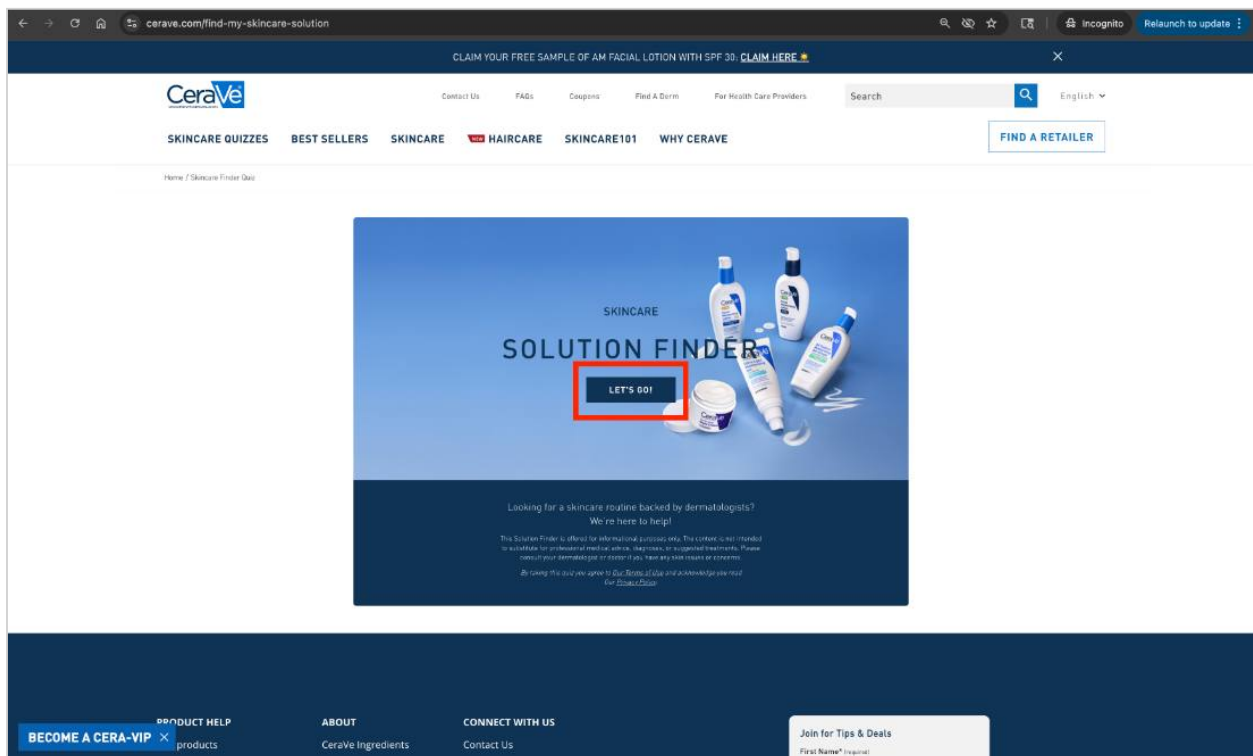
Step 1 — Quiz section on homepage



Step 2 — Take the quiz



Step 3 — Let's go!



Step 4 — Quiz questions (1 of 5)

cerave.com/find-my-skincare-solution

SKINCARE QUIZZES BEST SELLERS SKINCARE HAIRCARE SKINCARE101 WHY CERAVE FIND A RETAILER

Home / Skincare Finder Quiz

Let's start with your facial skincare.
Please select and rank your top two concerns.

NEED ADVICE? ACCESS HERE. ⓘ

Skin Texture/Dullness	Wrinkles and Fine Lines	Active Acne Breakout
Help Prevent New Acne	Dry Skin	Dark Spots
Dark Circles & Puffiness Around Eyes	Post-Acne Marks	General Skincare Routine
Prefer Not to Answer		

< BACK CONFIRM >

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Step 4 — Quiz questions (2 of 5)

cerave.com/find-my-skincare-solution

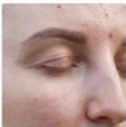
SKINCARE QUIZZES BEST SELLERS SKINCARE HAIRCARE SKINCARE101 WHY CERAVE FIND A RETAILER

Home / Skincare Finder Quiz

How does the skin on your face typically feel?

Select one

NEED ADVICE? CLICK HERE. ⓘ

			
Dry My whole face feels tight and flaky.	Oily My whole face feels greasy and looks shiny.	Combination I feel tightness on my cheeks, but my nose and forehead are shiny.	Normal/Balanced My whole face feels pretty even, not too oily, and not too dry.

< BACK

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Step 4 — Quiz questions (3 of 5)

cerave.com/find-my-skincare-solution

SKINCARE QUIZZES BEST SELLERS SKINCARE HAIRCARE SKINCARE101 WHY CERAVE FIND A RETAILER

Home / Skincare Finder Quiz

Where do you wear makeup regularly?
Select one

To find the most ideal cleanser for you, identify the areas you most often wear makeup

I don't wear makeup Eye areas only Everywhere (eyes/face)

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PRODUCT HELP ABOUT CONNECT WITH US
Our products CeraVe Ingredients Contact Us
BECOME A CERA-VIP x pons Skin Smarts Countries And Regions

Join for Tips & Deals
First Name* (required)
First Name*

Step 4 — Quiz questions (4 of 5)

cerave.com/find-my-skincare-solution

SKINCARE QUIZZES BEST SELLERS SKINCARE HAIRCARE SKINCARE101 WHY CERAVE FIND A RETAILER

Home / Skincare Finder Quiz

Let's talk sunscreen! How would you prefer to apply it?
WHY WE ASK ⓘ

Sunscreen applied separately Sunscreen combined with my moisturizer

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PRODUCT HELP ABOUT CONNECT WITH US
Our products CeraVe Ingredients Contact Us
BECOME A CERA-VIP x pons Skin Smarts Countries And Regions

Join for Tips & Deals
First Name* (required)
First Name*

Step 4 — Quiz questions (5 of 5)

cerave.com/find-my-skincare-solution

SKINCARE QUIZZES BEST SELLERS SKINCARE HAIRCARE SKINCARE101 WHY CERAVE FIND A RETAILER

Home / Skincare Finder Quiz

Now let's talk about your body, what is your main concern?
This will allow us to provide personalized products just for you.

Select one.

NEED ADVICE? CLICK HERE ⓘ

Itchy Skin	Eczema*	Psoriasis*
Cracked, Chafed Skin	Diabetic Skin	Rough & Bumpy Skin
Dry Skin	Very Dry Skin	Body Acne*
General Bodycare	Prefer Not to Answer	

< BACK SHOW RESULTS >

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Step 5 — Show results

cerave.com/find-my-skincare-solution

SKINCARE QUIZZES BEST SELLERS SKINCARE HAIRCARE SKINCARE101 WHY CERAVE FIND A RETAILER

Home / Skincare Finder Quiz

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Cracked, Chafed Skin	Diabetic Skin	Rough & Bumpy Skin
Dry Skin	Very Dry Skin	Body Acne*
General Bodycare	Prefer Not to Answer	

< BACK SHOW RESULTS >

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Step 6 — No thanks, take me to results

cerave.com/find-my-skincare-solution

SKINCARE QUIZZES BEST SELLERS SKINCARE HAIRCARE SKINCARE101 WHY CERAVE

FIND A RETAILER

Home / Skincare Finder Quiz

Want to stay in the loop with CeraVe?

Sign up to receive a coupon to save on your recommended products, and to be the first to know about new products, skincare tips, and special offers.

First name *

Last name *

Email *

* Required Fields

☐ We collect and process personal information that may be 'sensitive' personal information or consumer health data, and by submitting this form you consent to the processing of this information as described in Our [Sensitive Personal Information Notice](#) and agree to all its terms. If you do not agree please do not submit this form.

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NO THANKS
TAKE ME TO MY RESULTS

SIGN ME UP
SEE RESULTS & COUPON

BECOME A CERA-VIP X

Step 7 — Recommended products

cerave.com/find-my-skincare-solution/my-skincare-solutions

SKINCARE QUIZZES BEST SELLERS SKINCARE HAIRCARE SKINCARE101 WHY CERAVE

FIND A RETAILER

Hi!

Here's your results. The perfect CeraVe products for you are:

WASH

CLEANSE

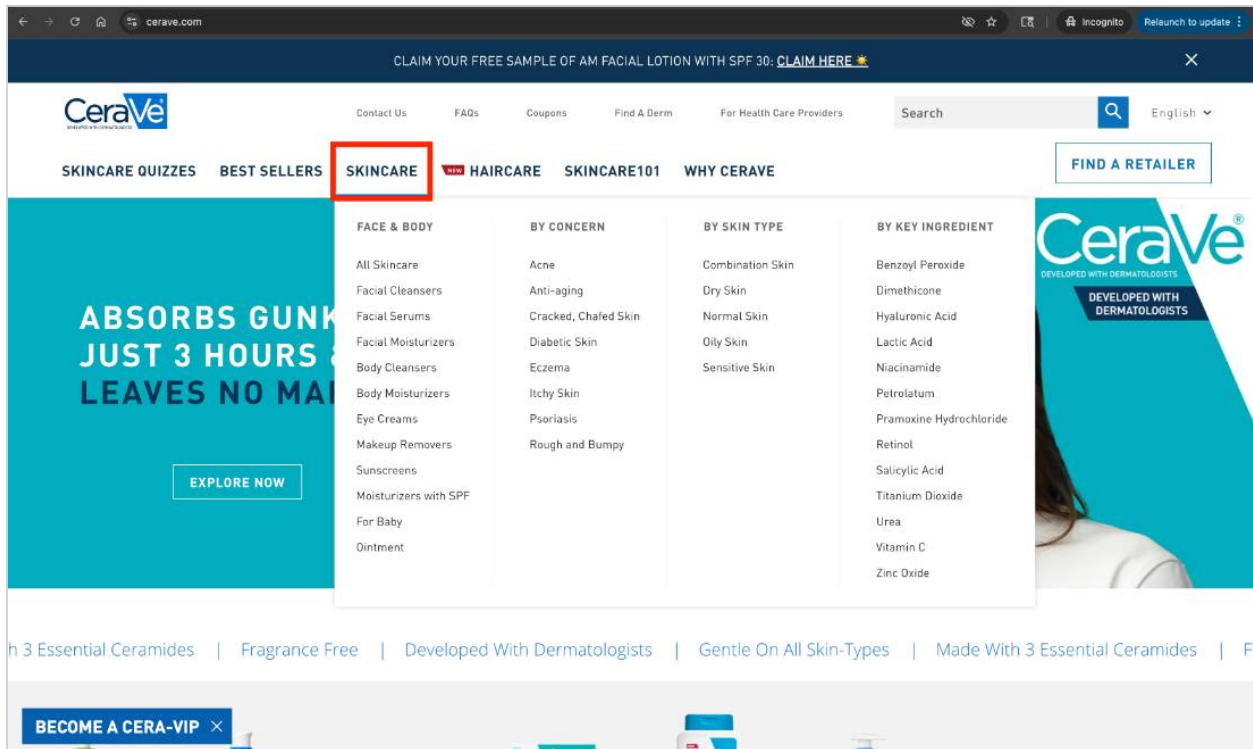
TREAT

MOISTURIZES & HELP PROTECT

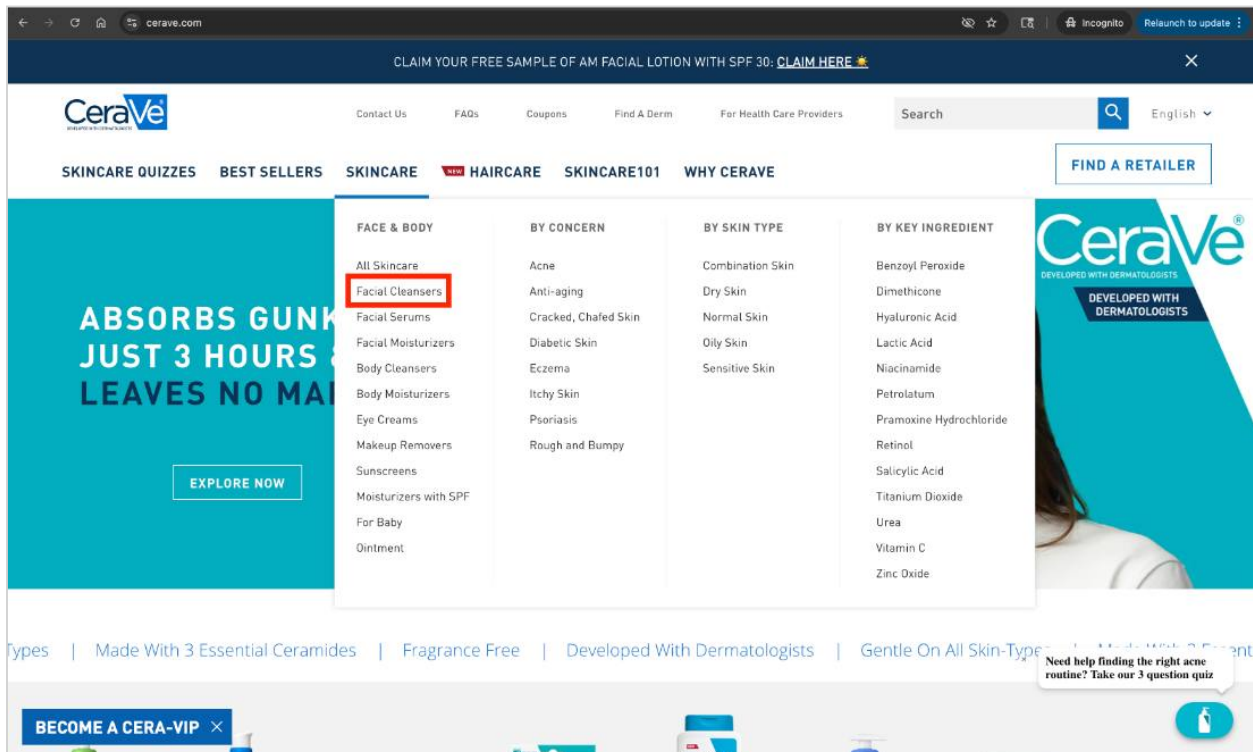
SET UP YOUR

Task 3 — Compare cleansers

Step 1 — Skincare menu



Step 2 — Facial Cleansers



Step 3 — Compare Facial Cleansers

cerave.com/skincare/cleansers/facial-cleansers

FACIAL CLEANSERS

Discover the Best CeraVe Facial Cleanser for Your Skin

Below, explore our range of facial cleansers and find the right option for your [skin type](#) and concerns.

COMPARE FACIAL CLEANSERS

Find The Right Cleanser For You!

BECOME A CERA-VIP × RESULTS: 19 PRODUCTS SORT BY RELEVANCE

SKINCARE CONCERNS

Step 4 — Locate the two cleansers

cerave.com/skincare/cleansers/facial-cleansers#product-compare__container

Find the Right Cleanser for You

 Hydrating Facial Cleanser ★★★★★ 4.6 BUY ONLINE	 Hydrating Foaming Oil Cleanser ★★★★★ 4.6 BUY ONLINE	 Renewing SA Cleanser ★★★★★ 4.6 BUY ONLINE	 Balancing Air Foam Facial Cleanser ★★★★★ 4.7 BUY ONLINE	 Foaming Facial Cleanser ★★★★★ 4.7 BUY ONLINE
SKIN TYPE Normal to Dry Skin	Dry to Very Dry Skin, Including Sensitive Skin	Normal Skin; Acne-Prone Skin	Normal, Combination, and Sensitive Skin Types	Normal to Oily Skin
CONCERN Cleansing	Lightweight Cleansing Oil for Face & Body	Gentle Exfoliation	Oil Control and Skin Hydration	Oil Control
KEY BENEFITS • Supports your protective skin barrier • Moisture balance while gently removing dirt, oil and makeup without leaving skin tight or dry	Transforms from an oil to a soft, lathering foam, gently releases your skin's surface without leaving a feeling tight or dry. Safe Suitable for Sensitive & Acne-Prone Skin	• Help exfoliate and smooth skin on face and body • Sweeps away dead cells, and softens rough skin—without leaving skin feeling dry	• Gentle Yet Effective Foam Cleanser • Supports A Healthy Looking Skin Barrier • Clinically Tested Oil Control And Hydration	• Refreshing gel foaming action • Cleanses and removes oil without disrupting the protective skin barrier
KEY INGREDIENTS Ceramides, Hyaluronic Acid ⓘ	Ceramides ⓘ	Ceramides, Salicylic Acid ⓘ	Glycolic Acid, Ceramides, Alantoin, Amino Acids ⓘ	Ceramides, Niacinamide ⓘ
TEXTURE Cream	Oil-to-Foam	Gel-to-Foam	Instant Lightweight Foam	Foaming Gel

BECOME A CERA-VIP × Find The Right Cleanser For You!

Step 5 — Comparison chart

cerave.com/skincare/cleaners/facial-cleaners#product-compare__container

Find the Right Cleanser for You

					
	Hydrating Facial Cleanser ★★★★★ 4.6	Hydrating Foaming Oil Cleanser ★★★★★ 4.6	Renewing SA Cleanser ★★★★★ 4.6	Balancing Air Foam Facial Cleanser ★★★★★ 4.7	Foaming Facial Cleanser ★★★★★ 4.7
	BUY ONLINE	BUY ONLINE	BUY ONLINE	BUY ONLINE	BUY ONLINE
SKIN TYPE	Normal to Dry Skin	Dry to Very Dry Skin, Including Sensitive Skin	Normal Skin; Acne-Prone Skin	Normal, Combination, and Sensitive Skin Types	Normal to Oily Skin
CONCERN	Cleansing	Lightweight, Cleansing Oil for Face & Body	Gentle Exfoliation	Oil Control and Skin Hydration	Oil Control
KEY BENEFITS	- Supports your protective skin barrier - Moisturize while gently removing dirt, oil and makeup without leaving skin tight or dry. Safe Suitable for Sensitive & Eczema-Prone Skin	Transforms from an oil to a soft lathering foam, gently releases your skin's surface without leaving it feeling tight or dry. Safe Suitable for Sensitive & Eczema-Prone Skin	- Help exfoliate and smooth skin on face and body - Sweeps away dead cells, and softens rough skin—without leaving skin feeling dry	- Gentle Yet Effective Foam Cleanser - Supports A Healthy-Looking Skin Barrier - Clinically Tested Oil Control And Hydration	- Refreshing gel foaming action - Cleanses and removes oil without disrupting the protective skin barrier
KEY INGREDIENTS	Ceramides, Hyaluronic Acid ⓘ	Ceramides ⓘ	Ceramides, Salicylic Acid ⓘ	Glycolic Acid, Ceramides, Allantoin, Amino Acids ⓘ	Ceramides, Niacinamide ⓘ
TEXTURE	Cream	Oil-to-Foam	Gel-to-Foam	Instant Lightweight Foam	Foaming Gel

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Find The Right Cleanser For You!